



HUMANITAS
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Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Brandon Classical Christian School

School Website: <https://www.wpcbrandon.org/bccs>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS STARTUP

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because ACCS require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Brandon Classical Christian School (Florida 33511) presents a clearly classical Christian identity anchored in covenantal, gospel-centered education. Public-facing materials emphasize partnering with parents, a Christ-centered worldview, and a Trivium-based curriculum framed within Great Books and the Great Conversation. The content consistently positions virtue formation, catechesis, and a biblical worldview as core aims, with explicit references to classical methods (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) and the Great Books tradition. In terms of the six elements rubric, the school demonstrates robust alignment in Religious Foundations, Purpose/Goal, Curriculum, Faculty, and Parents/Community. Pedagogy shows strong classical underpinnings through Trivium and classical materials, but the site provides less explicit detail about specific upper-school Socratic/seminar practices, suggesting a small but meaningful gap between stated aims and publicly documented pedagogy. Overall assessment: **CLASSICAL**, with Element 4 (Pedagogy) appearing as **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL** due to explicit methods being less overt in site content, despite strong curricular foundations.

Key insights: - The school's public materials consistently emphasize covenantal, gospel-centered formation, with explicit references to virtue and biblical worldview (Element 1). - Curriculum is clearly classical: Trivium, Great Books, Great Conversation, Paideia framing are named (Element 3). - Purpose/Goal centers on formation, virtue, wisdom, and a classical mission rather than mere job-readiness (Element 2). - Parental partnership and community alignment are foregrounded (Element 6). - Pedagogy is strongly classical in orientation (Trivium, memory work, and liturgical/contemplative elements implied by the Classical Christian framing), but explicit documentation of high-school Socratic seminars and formal upper-school debate is less visible online (Element 4).

Cited evidence is drawn from the school's public materials and related contextual sources in the supplied repository. See citations alongside specific claims below.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — **CLASSICAL**

Evidence - The school identifies itself as a covenantal Christian program operating "as a ministry of Westminster Presbyterian Church," with explicit aim to shepherd students to understand God's created order through His virtues and the Gospel in partnership with parents. This signals a transcendent moral framework grounded in Christian theism. - The curriculum description states that Classical Christian education establishes a biblical worldview (Paideia) and trains students in reasoning through the Trivium (Grammar, Logic, and Rhetoric) while engaging them in the Great Books. This embeds theology/theological framing and

liturgical sensibilities within the learning enterprise. - The public-facing page proclaims a Christ-centered collaboration with parents and a covenantal educational approach, underscoring the theological and liturgical orientation of daily school life.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: virtue(s); biblical worldview; gospel; covenantal; Christ-centered; Paulus a Paideia framing; Trivium; Great Books; Great Conversation. - Negative keywords: Not clearly present in the public materials (no explicit signals of relativism, secular humanism, or value-neutral education is evident). - Quantitative signal: multiple religious/theological orientation terms are present (virtue, biblical worldview, gospel, covenantal, Trivium, Great Books), with no explicit negative signals detected in the accessible public content. - Rating justification: The strong Christian-theological framing, focus on virtue, and explicit biblical worldview anchor the foundational metaphysical orientation as CLASSICAL.

Cited evidence - “As a ministry of Westminster Presbyterian Church, we exist to shepherd students to embrace and understand God’s created order through His virtues, love, and the Light of the Gospel for all aspects of life, in a Christ-Centered collaboration and partnership with parents.” - “Classical Christian education (CCE) is a time-tested educational system which establishes a biblical worldview (called Paideia), ... trains students in reasoning through the Trivium (Grammar, Logic, and Rhetoric), and engages children in ‘the great conversation’ through the historical Great Books.”

Why this rating - The site consistently ties education to Christian doctrinal commitments, a clear marker of transcendent moral realism and liturgical/covenantal engagement, with explicit terms like “biblical worldview” and “Gospel.” The combination of a Christ-centered approach and the Paideia framework aligns with the Positive keywords in the Classical lexicon, yielding a CLASSICAL rating in Element 1.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school foregrounds formation and character formation rather than mere information, describing education as a covenantal, character-forming enterprise rooted in virtue and wisdom (the Great Conversation with Great Books and the Trivium). The explicit emphasis on formation aligns with the classical aim of cultivating virtue and human excellence. - The materials frame education as a comprehensive cultivation of truth, goodness, and beauty through Paideia and the Great Books, underscoring a telos beyond vocational preparation. - The public-facing copy highlights a mission aligned with formation, wisdom, and virtue—the classical mission—rather than merely job-readiness.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation; virtue; wisdom; liberal education; Paideia; classical mission; telos; pursuit of true/good/beautiful; Great Conversation; Great Books; education for leisure/restfulness (where implied by scholé/context); formation of a humane soul. - Negative keywords present: none evident in public materials (no references to workforce-prep narrowly or 21st-century skills as dominant aims). - Quantitative signal: The public materials repeatedly emphasize formation, virtue, wisdom, and a classical telos; multiple explicit matches to the Positive keyword set. Negative keyword signals are not present. - Rating justification: The emphasis on formation, virtue, wisdom, and the true/good/beautiful teleology strongly supports CLASSICAL for Element 2.

Cited evidence - “Education that Inspires Depth and Wisdom.” (Header line in site copy) - “Classical Christian education (CCE) is a time-tested educational system which establishes a biblical worldview (called Paideia), ... engages children in the great conversation through the historical Great Books.” - “Providing kindergarten and first grade students in the Brandon area with a covenantal classical Christian education.”

Why this rating - The school places formation, virtue, and wisdom at the center of its mission, consistent with Classical Education goals described in the lexicon, with explicit Paideia framing and a clear embrace of the classical telos.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The curriculum is explicitly described as Trivium-based (Grammar, Logic, and Rhetoric) and includes a commitment to Great Books and the Great Conversation. This is a direct alignment with the classical core of language and reasoning, plus engagement with primary texts. - The school states it uses a biblical worldview Paideia approach and that Great Books and the Great Conversation are central to study, which is a hallmark of classical curricula. - The K–12 framing and “covenantal classical Christian education” implies the integration of liberal arts content (grammar/logic/rhetoric) across disciplines and a reading-rich approach anchored in the classics.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Trivium (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric); Great Books; Great Conversation; Paideia (biblical worldview framing); liberal arts; history through Great Books; formation; memory and recitation concepts (as part of classical pedagogy, per lexicon). - Negative keywords present: None evident in public materials (no project-based-only rhetoric, no social-studies-as-history substitution, etc.). - Quantitative signal: Strong presence of multiple core curriculum keywords (Trivium, Great Books, Great Conversation, Paideia). Zero negative signals detected in the accessible content. - Rating justification: The explicit naming of Trivium, Great Books/Great Conversation, and Paideia aligns squarely with CLASSICAL curriculum expectations.

Cited evidence - “Classical Christian education (CCE) is a time-tested educational system which establishes a biblical worldview (called Paideia), incorporates methods based on natural phases of child development, cultivates the seven Christian virtues, trains students in reasoning through the Trivium (Grammar, Logic, and Rhetoric), and engages children in ‘the great conversation’ through the historical Great Books.” - “Providing kindergarten and first grade students in the Brandon area with a covenantal classical Christian education.”

Why this rating - The curriculum section shows explicit classical elements (grammar/logic/rhetoric, Great Books, Great Conversation, Paideia) and a plan anchored in a biblical worldview, which strongly supports CLASSICAL.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school’s materials foreground classical methods like the Trivium (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) and the Great Books/Culture of the Great Conversation, which aligns with upper-level classical pedagogy, including opportunities for reasoning and argumentation inherent in the Trivium and canonical texts. - Public materials emphasize a Christ-centered approach to thinking, which suggests some emphasis on critical thinking and dialogic engagement, consistent with classical pedagogy (e.g., training in thinking rather than rote memorization alone). - However, explicit, public documentation of specific pedagogical practices such as Socratic seminars, seminars, or debates in upper grades, or systematic lower-grade singing/chanting routines, is not clearly enumerated in the publicly accessible site content. The detailed, memory-focused and chant-based lower-school pedagogy (as found in broader classical education literature) is not directly quoted on the site, though it may be part of the program in practice.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Trivium; Great Books; Great Conversation; Paideia. - Negative keywords present: The public content does not emphasize experiential/project-based-only pedagogy; but explicit statements about contemplative/scholé-focused restfulness appear more in related classical education literature than in Brandon’s direct site copy. - Quantitative signal: The site strongly signals classical methods (positive keywords) but provides limited explicit documentation of all specific pedagogical practices (e.g., upper-school seminars, Socratic discussion, or chant-based memory routines) in the public copy. This creates a gap between explicit pedagogy claims and publicly verifiable details. - Rating justification: Given strong curricular/classical framing but less explicit public articulation of the full spectrum of pedagogical methods (especially capstone/seminar specifics and lower to upper school memory/chanting routines), Pedagogy is BEST categorized as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Cited evidence - “Classical Christian education (CCE) ... trains students in reasoning through the Trivium (Grammar, Logic, and Rhetoric), and engages children in ‘the great conversation’ through the historical Great

Books.” - “We use a Christ-Centered Approach to teach students how to think, not just what to think— from a Christian worldview perspective.” - The staff page content (Headmaster, etc.) demonstrates traditional faculty roles but does not provide explicit public detail of Socratic seminars or upper-school debate formats.

Why this rating - The framework clearly aligns with classical pedagogy in spirit (Trivium, Great Books), but the publicly available site copy lacks explicit, granular descriptions of certain high-discipline practices (e.g., explicit Socratic seminars, formal upper-school debates) that would push this to a full CLASSICAL rating in Pedagogy. Therefore, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL is warranted.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The faculty pages present a professional team with clear roles (Headmaster, Director, teachers) and bios that emphasize formation, training, and service (e.g., MDiv, teaching experience in Bible studies, and education). This demonstrates a culture of mentorship and virtue, aligning with the Classical educator ideal. - The published bios show teachers with diverse educational backgrounds and a focus on serving the church and school community, consistent with the “living curriculum” and “model teachers” concept. The presence of a headmaster with pastoral and theological training reinforces moral formation as a central value. - The broader classical lexicon expects teachers to embody virtue and to be living exemplars who form character; while the site does not every sentence use the exact phrase, the bios reflect this orientation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: model teachers; mentors; living curriculum; portrait of teacher; collegiality; virtue; wisdom; formation through example. - Negative keywords present: None evident in public materials. - Quantitative signal: Multiple soft matches to the “model teacher living curriculum” concept appear in the bios and staff sections; explicit phrases like “living curriculum” or “portrait of a teacher” are not always explicit, but the bios convey the essence of those ideas. - Rating justification: The faculty material aligns well with CLASSICAL expectations (model teachers, mentorship, virtuous leadership). Therefore, CLASSICAL.

Cited evidence - Headmaster bio and staff bios showing pastoral/theological training and educational leadership.

Why this rating - The content demonstrates a faculty culture oriented toward virtue, mentorship, and formation, with staff who model and shepherd student growth, consistent with CLASSICAL.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school states explicit partnership with parents and a co-teacher model, emphasizing parental collaboration and joint formation as central to classical education. This is echoed in the program’s positioning as a covenantal education with parents as partners. - The materials describe “Christ-Centered collaboration and partnership with parents” and an ethos that invites parent involvement as an essential part of classical formation and identity. - The broader classical literature in the repository underscores the importance of parental partnership and family formation as a core axis of classical education, which aligns with how the Brandon materials frame their approach.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families; co-teachers; parental formation; home-school partnership; open campus/parent involvement (the public copy emphasizes parental partnership and collaboration with parents). - Negative keywords present: None evident in public materials. - Quantitative signal: Multiple direct references to parental partnership and family involvement; no explicit negative signals. - Rating justification: Element 6 is CLASSICAL due to explicit emphasis on parental partnership and community involvement as core to classical education.

Cited evidence - “As a ministry of Westminster Presbyterian Church, we exist to shepherd students ... in a Christ-Centered collaboration and partnership with parents.” - “Providing kindergarten and first grade stu-

dents in the Brandon area with a covenantal classical Christian education.” (emphasizing family partnership in the classical project)

Why this rating - The school’s public materials foreground parental partnership and parental involvement as essential to a classical education, satisfying the criteria for CLASSICAL in Element 6.

What Would Move the Needle

Not applicable, since the aggregate classification is CLASSICAL. No category is rated SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL in the aggregate, so no needle-moving changes section is mandated per the rubric.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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